

The Cognitive Funnel & The Universal Triad

How the 4-stage problem-solving motion powers the 3 concentric rings across Mind, Delivery, Leadership & Awareness.

ONE-PAGE
ARCHITECTURE

Motion Meets
Structure

1 REFLECT

▼ WIDEST APERTURE

"Wait, what is actually happening right now?"

Ring 2: Core + Center

 MIND
(COGNITIVE)

Self-Critique & Memory

Halt knee-jerk guesses. Measure doubt before answering; audit past failed attempts with zero defensiveness.

 DELIVERY (PM)
Risk Radar & Reality

Gather raw logs and true system state. Never paper over early warning signs or project slippage.

 LEAD
(LEADERSHIP)

Radical Truth Culture

Reward the first person who surfaces bad news. Kill "yes-man" bias and defensive posturing across the room.

 AWARENESS
(MINDFUL)

Notice the Impulse

Take one breath before speaking. Ask: "Am I observing the truth, or am I reacting out of anxiety?"

2 REFRAME

▼ PROBLEM FILTER

"Are we even solving the right problem?"

Ring 3: Outer (The World)

 MIND
(COGNITIVE)

People Empathy

Look through user, customer, or adversary lenses. Distinguish unstated core intent from superficial requests.

 DELIVERY (PM)
Scope Alignment

Challenge legacy assumptions. Prevent building an elegant feature that nobody actually needs or uses.

 LEAD
(LEADERSHIP)

Creative Reinvention

Reframe industry shifts into opportunities. Question whether the existing business model still fits reality.

 AWARENESS
(MINDFUL)

Listen Fully

Give 100% undivided outward attention. Notice internal resistance or avoidance when someone challenges the premise.

3 ANALYZE

▼ OPTION DISSECTION

"What are the candidate paths & trade-offs?"

Ring 1: Inner (The Engine)

 MIND
(COGNITIVE)

Root-Cause Logic

Drill to hard facts and axioms. Run "what-if" models, map failure cascades, and stress-test every alternative.

 DELIVERY (PM)
Critical Path & Cost

Calculate timelines, resource constraints, and blockers. Compare candidate plans against hard physical deadlines.

 LEAD
(LEADERSHIP)

Strategic Trade-offs

Say no to 99 good distractions. Quantify risk exposure and verify where the company's real leverage lies.

 AWARENESS
(MINDFUL)

Honest Reality Check

Check internal biases. Ask: "Is this candidate option backed by measurable evidence or by personal wishful thinking?"

4 SYNTHESIZE

 THE NARROWEST CHOICE

"Which 1 path do we pick, and why does it win?"

Unified Integration

 MIND
(COGNITIVE)

Decisive Selection

Cut through analysis paralysis. Choose the single winning solution and clearly articulate the exact rationale.

 DELIVERY (PM)
Bottom-Line Action

Ship with verified rollbacks. Communicate the final decision in sentence one with single accountability.

 LEAD
(LEADERSHIP)

Executive Direction

Unify the entire team behind the chosen path. Turn cold analytical trade-offs into high-conviction action.

 AWARENESS
(MINDFUL)

Present Commitment

Act without second-guessing or scattered attention. Bring total calm presence to executing the chosen path.

THE RHYTHM VS. THE ARCHITECTURE

The **Universal Triad** is your structural compass (Inner physics, Core integrity, Outer world). The **Cognitive Funnel** is the operational motion: when reality strikes, open wide (Reflect), pivot angle (Reframe), crunch options (Analyze), and commit to one with total clarity (Synthesize).

THE FRACTAL LAW OF EXECUTION

1 mind thinking through a complex decision → 10 people delivering a software project → 10,000 people leading a global enterprise. The funnel rhythm never changes: wide observation narrows to one high-conviction decision backed by clear rationale.